

in the londes as touching their abhominacions, namely of the Cananites, Hethites, Pherefites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egipcians, and Amorites. For they haue taken the daughters of the same, and their sonnes, and haue myrte the holy sede with synacions in the londes: and the hande of the rulers and lordes of counsell hath bene prin cipall in this trespase.

Whan I herde this, I rente my clothes and my rayment, and plucked out the heer of my heade and of my beard, and sat mournynge. And there resorted vnto me all such as feared the worde of the LORDE God of Israel because of the greate transgression. And I sat mournynge vntill the euenynge sacrifice. And aboute the euenynge sacrifice I rose vp fro my heuyenes, and rente my clothes and my raiment, and fell vpon my knees, and spred out my handes vnto the LORDE my God, and sayde:

My God, I am ashamed, and darre not lifte vp mine eyes vnto the my God: for oure wickednesses are growne ouer oure heade, and oure trespases are woren greates vnto synacion. Sence the tyme of oure fathers haue we bene in greates trespase vnto this daie, and because of oure wickednesses haue we and syninges bene deliuered in to the hande of syninges of the nacions, in to the swerde, in to captiuitie, in to spoyle, and in to confusion of face, as it is come to passe this daie.

But now is there a litle and sodane graciousnes come from the LORDE oure God, so that some of vs are escaped, that he maie geue vs a nayle in his holy place, that oure God maye lighte oure eyes, and geue vs a litle lyfe in oure bondage. For we are bondmen, and God hath not forsake vs though we be bondmen, and hath enclined mercy vnto vs in the sighte of the syninges of Persia, that they shulde geue vs lyfe, and promote the house of oure God, and to sett vp the desolacion therof, and to geue vs an hed ge in Juda and Jerusalem.

O oure God, what shal we saye now after this? that we haue forsaken thy commandementes, which thou hast commanded by thy seruantes the prophetes, and saide: The londe wherin ye shal come to possesse it, is an vnclane londe thorow the synithines of the people of the londes, in their abhominacions wherwith they haue made it full of vnclannes on every syde. Therefore shal ye not geue youre daughters vnto their sonnes, and their daughters shal ye not take vnto youre sonnes, and sette not their pea-

ce and welch for ever, that ye maye be stronge, and enioye the good in the londe, and ye and youre children maye haue the inheritance of it for evermore.

And after all this that is come vpon vs (because of oure euell dedes and greates trespases) thou oure God hast spared oure wickednesses, and hast genen vs a deliuerance as it is come to passe.

As for vs, we haue turned backe, and haue let go thy commandementes, to make contracte with the people of these abhominacions. Wilt thou then be wroth at vs, till we be utterly consumed, so that nothyng remaine, and till there be no deliuerance? O LORDE God of Israel, thou art righteous, for we remaine yet escaped, as it is this daie. Beholde, in thy presence are we in oure trespase, for because of it is there no standinge before the.

The X. Chapter.

Whan Esdras prayed after this maner and knowleged, wepte, and lay before the house of God, there resorted vnto him out of Israel a very greates congregacion of men and women, and children: the people wepte very sore. And Sachania the sonne of Jehiel one of the children of Elam, answered, and sayde vnto Esdras: We haue trespassed agaynst the LORDE oure God, in that we haue taken straunge wyues of all the people of the londe. Now there is hope yet in Israel concerninge this, therefore let vs make a couenaunt now with oure God, that we shal put awaye all the wyues (and such as are borne of them) acordinge to the counsell of syn LORDE, and of them that feare the commandement of oure God, if we maye do acordinge to the lawe. Get the vp therfore, for the matter belongeth vnto the. We wyll be with the, be of good comfort, and do it.

Then rose Esdras, and toke an othe of the rulers, prestes and Leuites, and of all Israel, that they shulde do acordinge to this worde: and they swore. And Esdras stood vp before the house of God, and wente in to the chamber of Johanan the sonne of Elisab. And whan he came thither, he akened bread, and dranke no water: for he mourned because of the transgression of them that had bene in captiuitie.

And they caused a proclamacion be made thorow out Juda and Jerusalem, vnto all the children which had bene in captiuitie, that they shulde gather them selues together vnto Jerusalem: And that who soeuer came out

within thre dayes acordinge to the denyce of the rulers and Elders, all his substance shulde be forfett, and he put out from the congregacion of the captiue.

Then all the men of Juda and Ben Jamin gathered them selues together vnto Jerusalem in thre dayes, and is on the twentieth daie of the nyenth moneth: and all the people sat in the strete before the house of God, and trembled because of the matter, and for the rayne. And Esdras the prest stood vp, and sayde vnto them: Ye haue transgressed, and ye haue taken straunge wyues, to make the trespase of Israel yet more: confesse now therfore vnto syn LORDE God of youre fathers, and do his pleasure, and separate youre selues from the people of the londe, and from syn straunge wyues. The answered all the congregacion, and sayde with loude voyce: Let it be done as thou hast sayde. But the people are many, and it is a raynye wether, and they can not stode here without, nether is this a worke of one daie or two, for we are many and haue offended in this transgression. Let vs appoynte oure rulers therfore in all the congregacion, and all they which haue taken straunge wyues in oure cities, maye come at the tyme appoynted, and the Elders of every cite and their Judges with them, till the wrath of oure God because of this matter be turned awaye from vs.

Then were appoynted Jonathan the sonne of Asahel and Jehasia the sonne of Thecua ouer this matter. And Nesullam and Sabai the Leuites helped them. And the children of the captiuitie dyd even so. And Esdras the prest, and syn auuncient fathers thorow the house of their fathers, and all that were now rehearsed by name, separated the selues, and sat them downe on the first daie of the tenth moneth, to examine this matter. And on syn first daie of syn first moneth broughte they the matter to a conclusion, concerninge all the men which had taken straunge wyues.

And amonge the children of the prestes there were men founde which had taken straunge wyues, namely amonge the children of Jesua the sonne of Josede and of his brethren, Maeseia, Elieser, Jarib and Godolia. And they gaue their handes there vpon, that they wolde put awaye their wyues: and for their trespase offerynge to geue a rāme for their trespase. Amonge the children of Immer, Hanani and Sabadia. Amonge the children of Harim, Maeseia, Elia, Semaia, Jehiel, and Ofa. Amonge syn children of Paslur, Elioenai, Maeseia, Ismael, Methaneel, Josabad and Eleasa. Amonge

the Leuites, Josabad, Simeel and Celaia, he is that Celita, Perhabia, Juda and Eleasar. Amonge the synners, Elyasib. Amonge the porters, Sallum, Telm and Uri.

Of Israel. Amonge the children of Pareos, Ramia, Jesia, Malchia, Metamin, Eleasar, Malchia and Benai. Amonge syn children of Elam, Mathania, Zachary, Jehiel, Abdy, Jeremoth and Elia. Amonge the children of Sathu, Elioenai, Elyasib, Mathania, Jeremoth, Sabad and Asifa. Amonge the children of Debai, Johanan, Hanania, Sabai and Achlai. Amonge the children of Bani, Nesullam, Mailuch, Adaia, Jasub, Seal and Jeremoth. Amonge the children of Parbath Moab, Adna, Chelal, Benai, Maesea, Mathania, Bezaleel, Benui and Manasse. Amonge the children of Harim, Elieser, Jesia, Malchia, Semaia, Simeon, Ben Jamin, Mailuch and Samaria. Amonge the children of Hasum, Mathnai, Mathatha, Sabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasse and Simeel. Amonge the children of Bani, Maedai, Amram, Zuel, Benai, Bedia, Chelui, Naia, Jeremoth, Elyasib, Mathania, Mathnai, Jaesau, Bani, Benui, Simeel, Selemia, Nathan, Adaia, Nachnadbai, Sasai, Sarai, Asareel, Selemia, Samaria, Sallum, Amaria, and Joseph. Amonge the children of Nebo, Zeiel, Mathithia, Sabad, Sebina, Jeddai, Joel, and Benai. All these had taken straunge wyues. And amonge the same wyues there were some, that had borne children.

The ende of the first boke of Esdras.

The seconde boke of Esdras, otherwyse called the boke of Nehemias.

What this boke conteyneth.

- Chap. I. Nehemias mourneth for the captiuitie of the people.
- Chap. II. Nehemias obtayneth licence of the synge Artaxerxes (otherwyse called Artahastha) to go vnto Jerusalem.
- Chap. III. Of buyldinge the cite.
- Chap. IV. The officers go aboute to hynder the buyldinge. The Jewes watch, and prepaye the selues to buylde and to fighte.
- Chap. V. Nehemias reproveth vsury.
- Chap. VI. The officers go aboute to fyll Nehemias.
- Chap. VII. The nombre of them that departed from Babilon.
- Chap. VIII. In the feast of the Tabernacles reade the boke of the lawe.